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General Comment

There is no such thing as “leadership” in the field laughably called “artificial intelligence,” just as there is (appropriately) no such thing as leadership in the field of serving as a fence for stolen goods. What is called “artificial intelligence” today is simply the camouflaged theft of intellectual property, and it would be one of America’s deepest shames to be a leader in it. If the U.S. values leadership in global markets of any kind, our goal should be to protect the products—including the intellectual and creative products—we produce. But AI is built on destroying such products, aggregating and adulterating original, valuable ideas and selling them at a discount. Is America a dubious wholesaler in original ideas produced elsewhere? If so, we should embrace AI and further it any way we can. If, on the other hand, America is a land of distinct and original genius that produces ideas worth fighting for, we must do everything we can to protect those ideas from their discounting, their cheapening, and their watering down at the hands of tech companies hoping to bundle them together into AI products. A real patriotic American would attack the loosening of copyright that AI requires; a cheap pimp of true ideas would embrace “AI leadership.” Which is America? I hope we’re a real source of inspiration and insight—if so, we will fight the AI tide. But perhaps we aren’t the nation I grew up believing we were. If we’re secondhand hacks, posers, and carnival barkers, we should fully endorse the “AI revolution.” If we’re better than that, we must fight it. I guess we’ll see, in the coming days, what America really thinks about itself and its role in the global future.